

How to pitch any podcast

Drawn from a review of real pitches sent to one interview show over several years. Hosts decide in seconds. These are the things that moved a pitch forward, and the things that ended it.

1 Lead with the story, not the résumé

Pitches that opened with credentials, a book title or a bio rarely advanced. The ones that moved forward put a specific human moment in the first lines.

3 Show you listened in the fit

Pitch the kind of story the show tells, in the format it uses. A compliment alone did not move pitches forward, and mass-blast openers are spotted immediately.

5 Keep it short and plain

A few short paragraphs in a plain email. Heavy graphics, media kits and long attachments tended to go with pitches that were declined.

7 Follow up once, then let it go

One polite nudge after a couple of weeks is normal. Repeated follow-ups with no new information cost goodwill and win nothing.

2 Pitch one guest and one angle

A list of topics reads as "I will talk about anything." Pick the single thing this host's audience would actually lean in for, and say it plainly.

4 Skip the prepared questions

Sending a list of suggested interview questions tells the host you want to run their show. Offer the person, and let the host find the conversation.

6 Make the ask small and clear

One request: would this person be a fit? Do not stack offers of free books, bundles or "additional materials" on top of it.

8 Take the answer well

Hosts often work alone and reply slowly. A gracious reply to a "no" is remembered, and is how people get a second look later.

TENDS TO END THE PITCH

An opening built from the guest's title, a long bulleted topic list, "suggested questions," and an offer to send a book.

TENDS TO MOVE IT FORWARD

A real name, one specific moment or story in two or three sentences, why it suits this show, and a single clear question.

Before you hit send

- ☐ I have read or listened to this show
- ☐ The first two lines are about a person, not a title
- ☐ One guest, one angle
- ☐ No attachments needed to understand it
- ☐ I know what I am asking for
- ☐ It is written to this host, not "Dear Podcaster"
- ☐ I am comfortable hearing "no"
- ☐ I have a plan for one follow-up, no more